

52 Family Talk-Along Cards

Good questions for dinner, the car, bath time
and bedtime.



Car

A PASSENGER R



5–12 · 44

What was the
part of your d
What was the
part?

Would you ra/
drive a bus, fl
plane or sail
Why?

What was a brave
thing you did this
week?

 **GROWN-UP TIP**
Go first with yours
when grown-ups!

 **GROWN-UP TIP**
Side-by-side talk fr
the road is fine.

 **GROWN-UP TIP**
Name the feeling: "You felt nervous,
and you did it anyway."

 **Dinner**

13 CARDS

 **Car**

13 CARDS

 **Bath**

13 CARDS

 **Bedtime**

13 CARDS

Prep: about 20 min to print and cut, once. No prep to ask a question.

Inside this download

- ✓ 54 poker-size cards: 52 questions + how-to + blank
- ✓ 9 cards per page, with cut lines and card backs
- ✓ Grown-up guide with 6 easy talk-along habits
- ✓ No-cut question pages: start tonight
- ✓ Make-your-own cards you can type into
- ✓ Cut-out labels for jars, bags and the glove box

Start here

Real talk happens in small moments: passing the peas, waiting at a red light, rinsing shampoo, turning off the lamp. These cards give those moments a good question.

How to use the cards

- 1 Match the card to the moment.**
Dinner cards at the table, car cards on the road, bath cards at the tub, bedtime cards at lights-out.
- 2 One card is plenty.**
A single good question can fill a whole meal. Put the rest back for tomorrow.
- 3 Everyone answers.**
Grown-ups too. Kids open up when they hear your answer first.
- 4 Use the grown-up tip.**
Each card has one small idea for keeping the talk going.
- 5 Keep it light.**
Anyone can say “pass.” It’s a conversation, not a quiz.

Four moments

 Dinner	CARDS 01–13 Keep them in a jar on the table.
 Car	CARDS 14–26 Keep them in the glove box or a door pocket.
 Bath	CARDS 27–39 Keep them by the sink in a zip bag.
 Bedtime	CARDS 40–52 Keep them on the nightstand or by the books.

Ages 5–7. Read the card aloud, give an example answer, and welcome short answers. Drawing an answer counts too.

Ages 8–12. Let them read the card and pick who goes first. Skip any that feel too young; bath cards suit tooth-brushing too.

6 talk-along habits

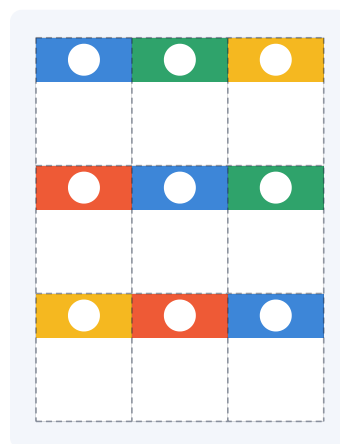
 Go first Answer the card yourself sometimes. Kids copy what they see.	 Ask “what else?” One gentle follow-up keeps a short answer going.	 Side by side Car rides and dish duty feel easier than face-to-face talks.
 Wait longer Count to five in your head. Big thoughts take a moment.	 Listen, don't fix Save advice for later. “Tell me more” goes a long way.	 Passing is okay Anyone can say “pass” and pull another card.
Why a question card? Kids often say more side by side than face to face. A card takes the pressure off: nobody is being quizzed, everyone gets a turn.	Three talk lines: “Tell me more.” · “What was that like?” · “I wonder...” Talk in the language you know best. Drawing, pointing or typing an answer counts too.	Most families love 2–3 of these and ask them again and again. Keep the favorites on top of the pile.

Some questions (the hard parts, the worries) can bring up big feelings. Listening is enough. If something your child shares worries you, reach out to your child’s doctor or another trusted professional.

BEFORE YOU PRINT

Print, cut and keep

- ✓ **Print at “Actual size” (100%).** Cards are standard poker size, 2.5 × 3.5 in (63.5 × 88.9 mm).
- ✓ **Use cardstock if you can.** Heavy paper or cardstock (65–110 lb / 176–300 gsm) feels like a real deck.
- ✓ **Edges cut off?** Choose “Fit” instead. The cards print a little smaller and still work.
- ✓ **Backs are optional.** Print the backs page on the reverse of a card sheet, flipping on the long edge. Test one sheet first.
- ✓ **Cut on the lines.** A paper trimmer is fastest. Grown-up keeps the pieces and does the cutting. No time? Use the no-cut pages today.
- ✓ **Make them last.** Laminate for sticky fingers. Keep them in a recipe box, a zip bag or on a ring.



9 cards per page · 6 pages · 54 cards
Prep: about 20 minutes to print and cut

✓ Safety basics

- In the car, a passenger reads the card. The driver keeps eyes on the road.
- Bath time: stay with your child. Keep the cards dry in a zip bag by the sink.
- Any question can be skipped. Nobody has to answer something that feels too big.
- If a big worry comes up, listen first. Solutions can wait for a calm moment.
- Grown-up keeps the pieces: cards, laminated cards and rings stay away from babies and toddlers.

Ways to use your deck

Question jar

One card a night at the dinner table.

Road-trip stack

A passenger reads; everyone answers.

Kid picks

Let your child choose the card, or ask it.

Family favorites

Keep the best ones and ask them again next year.

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Start tonight, cut later

Read a question straight from this page. The grown-up tip is in italics.



Dinner

Keep them in a jar on the table.

- 01 **What was the best part of your day? What was the trickiest part?** *Go first with yours. Kids open up when grown-ups share too.*
- 02 **If you could invent a brand-new food, what would be in it? What would you call it?** *Play along with silly answers. Silly keeps the talk going.*
- 03 **Who made you smile today? What did they do?** *Listen for new names and ask one more question about them.*
- 04 **If our family had a holiday that was just ours, what would we do on it?** *Write down the best idea, and try it for real.*
- 05 **What's something you're getting better at?** *Notice the effort: "You kept practicing."*
- 06 **If you could have dinner with any animal, which one would you pick? What would you talk about?** *Ask one follow-up question before you share your own answer.*
- 07 **What's one thing you'd love to learn how to do?** *Ask what the very first step might be.*
- 08 **If you were in charge of the house for a day, what rule would you make?** *Skip the correcting. Ask, "Why that rule?"*
- 09 **What's a question you've always wanted to ask me?** *Answer honestly and briefly, then ask it back.*
- 10 **What made you laugh this week?** *Laugh along. Retelling a funny moment is storytelling practice.*
- 11 **If you had a superpower just for helping people, what would it be?** *Ask who they would help first.*
- 12 **Describe your perfect weekend, from breakfast to bedtime.** *Ask for details: "What would it smell like? Sound like?"*
- 13 **What's something kind that someone did for you lately?** *Say thanks for sharing. It doesn't need to become a lesson.*



Car

A passenger reads; the driver just talks.

- 14 **Would you rather drive a bus, fly a plane or sail a boat? Why?** *Side-by-side talk feels easy. Eyes on the road is fine.*
- 15 **Pick someone you can see outside. Make up a story about where they're going.** *Take turns adding one sentence each.*
- 16 **If this car could take us anywhere in one second, where would we go?** *Ask what they would pack.*
- 17 **What song should be our family's theme song?** *Let them pick the next song and ask why they like it.*
- 18 **What's something you're looking forward to?** *Share something you're looking forward to as well.*
- 19 **If you designed a playground, what would it have?** *Ask them to describe it so clearly you could draw it.*
- 20 **Pick a color. How many things that color can we spot before we get there?** *Count out loud together. Younger kids can point.*
- 21 **What would you do if you were the grown-up and I were the kid today?** *Laugh along, then ask what they'd do the same as you.*
- 22 **What's the hardest part of being a kid right now?** *Just listen. "That sounds hard" is enough.*
- 23 **What's a game, show or video you like right now? What's the best part?** *Be curious, not a critic. Ask them to explain it to you.*
- 24 **Tell me about a dream you remember.** *Ask what they think it meant. There are no wrong answers.*
- 25 **What's something you know a lot about? Teach me one thing.** *Be the curious student. Ask a real question.*
- 26 **Think of an animal. I'll ask yes-or-no questions until I guess it.** *Swap roles so they practice asking the questions.*

Start tonight, cut later

Read a question straight from this page. The grown-up tip is in italics.



Bath

Grown-up stays close. Keep this page dry.

- 27 **If you could swim with any sea creature, which one would you choose?** *Ask what it would feel like to touch it.*
- 28 **What would a fish say about our bathtub?** *Answer back in your best fish voice.*
- 29 **What felt hard today? What helped?** *Warm water and a calm voice make this a gentle time to ask.*
- 30 **If a bubble could carry a message anywhere, what would yours say?** *Blow the message away together.*
- 31 **What's your favorite smell in the whole world? Why?** *Share yours. Smells often bring back stories.*
- 32 **If you were a raindrop, where would you want to land?** *Ask, "And then what happens?"*
- 33 **Invent a new bath toy. What does it do?** *Ask them to give it a name and a sound.*
- 34 **What makes someone a good friend?** *Ask for an example from their day.*
- 35 **Would you rather live under the sea or up in the clouds?** *Ask about the trickiest part of living there.*
- 36 **You just found a new planet. What's its name, and who lives there?** *Build the world together, one detail each.*
- 37 **What's something you like about yourself?** *Leave a pause. Then share something you like about them.*
- 38 **Close your eyes. How many sounds can you hear right now?** *Listen quietly first, then compare lists.*
- 39 **If you shrank to the size of a rubber duck, what would you explore?** *Follow their lead and keep asking, "Then what?"*



Bedtime

Keep them on the nightstand or by the books.

- 40 **What are three good things from today?** *Keep it small. A snack, a joke or a sunny minute all count.*
- 41 **What's something you're wondering about?** *"I don't know. Let's find out tomorrow" is a great answer.*
- 42 **If you could choose tonight's dream, what would it be?** *Speak slowly and softly. Calm voices help everyone wind down.*
- 43 **Who is someone you're thankful for? Why?** *Ask if they'd like to tell that person tomorrow.*
- 44 **What was a brave thing you did this week?** *Name the feeling: "You felt nervous, and you did it anyway."*
- 45 **What's your favorite memory of our family?** *Share one of your favorite memories of them.*
- 46 **If your stuffed animal could talk, what would it say about your day?** *Let the toy answer in its own voice.*
- 47 **What's something you'd like to do together this weekend?** *Pick one idea and put it on the calendar.*
- 48 **Was there anything that worried you today?** *Listen first. Solutions can wait until morning.*
- 49 **Start a story: "Once upon a time, a tiny dragon..."** *Take turns adding one line until someone yawns.*
- 50 **What would you love to be really good at when you grow up?** *Ask what they love about it.*
- 51 **If today were weather, what would it be? Sunny, cloudy, stormy?** *Accept every answer. Feelings aren't right or wrong.*
- 52 **What do you want to remember about today?** *End with the same goodnight words every night.*

START HERE

How to talk along

- 1 Pick a card that fits the moment.
- 2 Read it out loud.
- 3 Everyone answers, grown-ups too.
- 4 "Pass" is always allowed.

 Dinner  Car
 Bath  Bedtime



✓ In the car, a passenger reads. The driver just talks.

Version 1.0 · September 2026



5-12 · 01

**What was the best part of your day?
What was the trickiest part?**

 GROWN-UP TIP

Go first with yours. Kids open up when grown-ups share too.



5-12 · 02

If you could invent a brand-new food, what would be in it? What would you call it?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Play along with silly answers. Silly keeps the talk going.



5-12 · 03

Who made you smile today? What did they do?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Listen for new names and ask one more question about them.



5-12 · 04

If our family had a holiday that was just ours, what would we do on it?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Write down the best idea, and try it for real.



5-12 · 05

What's something you're getting better at?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Notice the effort: "You kept practicing."



5-12 · 06

If you could have dinner with any animal, which one would you pick? What would you talk about?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Ask one follow-up question before you share your own answer.



5-12 · 07

What's one thing you'd love to learn how to do?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what the very first step might be.



5-12 · 08

If you were in charge of the house for a day, what rule would you make?

 GROWN-UP TIP

Skip the correcting. Ask, "Why that rule?"



5-12 · 09

What's a question you've always wanted to ask me?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Answer honestly and briefly, then ask it back.



5-12 · 10

What made you laugh this week?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Laugh along. Retelling a funny moment is storytelling practice.



5-12 · 11

If you had a superpower just for helping people, what would it be?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask who they would help first.



5-12 · 12

Describe your perfect weekend, from breakfast to bedtime.

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask for details: "What would it smell like? Sound like?"



5-12 · 13

What's something kind that someone did for you lately?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Say thanks for sharing. It doesn't need to become a lesson.



5-12 · 14

Car

A PASSENGER READS

Would you rather drive a bus, fly a plane or sail a boat? Why?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Side-by-side talk feels easy. Eyes on the road is fine.



5-12 · 15

Car

A PASSENGER READS

Pick someone you can see outside. Make up a story about where they're going.

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Take turns adding one sentence each.



5-12 · 16

Car

A PASSENGER READS

If this car could take us anywhere in one second, where would we go?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask what they would pack.



5-12 · 17

Car

A PASSENGER READS

What song should be our family's theme song?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Let them pick the next song and ask why they like it.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 18

What's something you're looking forward to?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Share something you're looking forward to as well.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 19

If you designed a playground, what would it have?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask them to describe it so clearly you could draw it.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 20

Pick a color. How many things that color can we spot before we get there?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Count out loud together. Younger kids can point.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 21

What would you do if you were the grown-up and I were the kid today?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Laugh along, then ask what they'd do the same as you.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 22

What's the hardest part of being a kid right now?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Just listen. "That sounds hard" is enough.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 23

What's a game, show or video you like right now? What's the best part?

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Be curious, not a critic. Ask them to explain it to you.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 24

Tell me about a dream you remember.

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask what they think it meant. There are no wrong answers.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 25

What's something you know a lot about? Teach me one thing.

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Be the curious student. Ask a real question.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 26

Think of an animal. I'll ask yes-or-no questions until I guess it.

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Swap roles so they practice asking the questions.



5-12 · 27

If you could swim with any sea creature, which one would you choose?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what it would feel like to touch it.



5-12 · 28

What would a fish say about our bathtub?

GROWN-UP TIP

Answer back in your best fish voice.



5-12 · 29

What felt hard today? What helped?

GROWN-UP TIP

Warm water and a calm voice make this a gentle time to ask.



5-12 · 30

If a bubble could carry a message anywhere, what would yours say?

GROWN-UP TIP

Blow the message away together.



5-12 · 31

What's your favorite smell in the whole world? Why?

GROWN-UP TIP

Share yours. Smells often bring back stories.



5-12 · 32

If you were a raindrop, where would you want to land?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask, "And then what happens?"



5-12 · 33

Invent a new bath toy. What does it do?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask them to give it a name and a sound.



5-12 · 34

What makes someone a good friend?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask for an example from their day.



5-12 · 35

Would you rather live under the sea or up in the clouds?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask about the trickiest part of living there.



5-12 · 36

You just found a new planet. What's its name, and who lives there?

GROWN-UP TIP

Build the world together, one detail each.



5-12 · 37

What's something you like about yourself?

GROWN-UP TIP

Leave a pause. Then share something you like about them.



5-12 · 38

Close your eyes. How many sounds can you hear right now?

GROWN-UP TIP

Listen quietly first, then compare lists.



5-12 · 39

If you shrank to the size of a rubber duck, what would you explore?

GROWN-UP TIP

Follow their lead and keep asking, "Then what?"



5-12 · 40

What are three good things from today?

GROWN-UP TIP

Keep it small. A snack, a joke or a sunny minute all count.



5-12 · 41

What's something you're wondering about?

GROWN-UP TIP

"I don't know. Let's find out tomorrow" is a great answer.



5-12 · 42

If you could choose tonight's dream, what would it be?

GROWN-UP TIP

Speak slowly and softly. Calm voices help everyone wind down.



5-12 · 43

Who is someone you're thankful for? Why?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask if they'd like to tell that person tomorrow.



5-12 · 44

What was a brave thing you did this week?

GROWN-UP TIP

Name the feeling: "You felt nervous, and you did it anyway."



5-12 · 45

What's your favorite memory of our family?

GROWN-UP TIP

Share one of your favorite memories of them.



5-12 · 46

If your stuffed animal could talk, what would it say about your day?

GROWN-UP TIP

Let the toy answer in its own voice.



5-12 · 47

What's something you'd like to do together this weekend?

GROWN-UP TIP

Pick one idea and put it on the calendar.



5-12 · 48

Was there anything that worried you today?

GROWN-UP TIP

Listen first. Solutions can wait until morning.



5-12 · 49

Start a story: "Once upon a time, a tiny dragon..."

GROWN-UP TIP

Take turns adding one line until someone yawns.



5-12 · 50

What would you love to be really good at when you grow up?

GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they love about it.



5-12 · 51

**If today were weather, what would it be?
Sunny, cloudy, stormy?**

GROWN-UP TIP

Accept every answer. Feelings aren't right or wrong.



5-12 · 52

What do you want to remember about today?

GROWN-UP TIP

End with the same goodnight words every night.

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question

+

OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



Talk-Along

Family cards · Ages 5–12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question

+

OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question

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OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question

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OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

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MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question

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OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question

+

OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

Where the cards live

Cards get used when they're already in the room. Split the deck into four piles, cut out these labels (a grown-up cuts and keeps the pieces), and tape each one to a jar, an envelope or a zip bag.



Dinner
TALK-ALONG CARDS 01–13

Keep them in a jar on the table.



Car
TALK-ALONG CARDS 14–26

Keep them in the glove box or a door pocket.



Bath
TALK-ALONG CARDS 27–39

Keep them by the sink in a zip bag.



Bedtime
TALK-ALONG CARDS 40–52

Keep them on the nightstand or by the books.

Our talk-along week

Check a box each time a card gets asked. Start on any day. Aim for a few checks, not a full grid.

	DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Dinner	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Car	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Bath	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Bedtime	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Our family's favorite question so far:

A question we want to add:

What's next

Thank you for playing first

Your files stay on your Etsy Purchases page, ready to download again any time. Open them in a web browser, not the app, and save them to Files or your computer.

Share a photo of your fridge checklist or your favorite card: sharing is always optional.

Next for your family



"I'm Bored" Play Cards

Ages 1–12 · 150 age-banded screen-free plays, each with a talk prompt



First Phone Agreement Kit

Ages 9–12 · a readiness checklist and a family agreement, for whenever the time is right



52 Play & Talk Cards

Ages 0–5 · for the little ones: one play and one talk tip per card

Find them all in our shop, **Play Before Pixels**. Bundles are offered at a fair discount.

Which card did your family love?

A short, honest review on the shop where you bought this helps other families decide. Questions or ideas? Send us a message through Etsy.



Play Before Pixels

52 Family Talk-Along Cards, Ages 5–12. Version 1.0 · September 2026. Printable PDF for personal and family use.

Parent education only. These cards are ideas for everyday play and conversation; they are not medical, developmental or professional advice and are not a substitute for care from a qualified professional. Supervise children as right for their age, especially near water and in the car.

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